

How to Create Realistic Images with Nano Banana Pro

What This Method Does

This workflow allows you to generate hyper realistic product photos, AI influencer content, or any scenario based imagery using Nano Banana Pro. The secret is using JSON code to control the visual quality, color grading, and realism of your outputs.

Why JSON Prompting Matters

Nano Banana Pro has one major flaw when you use standard text prompts: grayscale color grading.

When you prompt the model directly without a reference structure, you get images that look washed out. They stick to four or five colors maximum. Sometimes they look realistic, sometimes they don't.

JSON prompting solves this by:

- Controlling exact color grading
- Maintaining realistic lighting
- Preserving visual styling details
- Multiplying your output quality by 10x

The JSON acts as a blueprint for realism. It handles all the technical details while you focus on what you want to create.

The Complete Workflow

Step 1: Find Your Reference Image

Go to Pinterest and search for the aesthetic you want.

Look for images that match:

- The lighting style you need
- The color palette you want
- The overall mood and composition
- The level of realism you're aiming for

Save the image that best matches your vision.

Step 2: Convert the Image to JSON Code

Upload your Pinterest reference to Gemini 3 Pro.

Use this prompt: **"Create me a very detailed JSON that can recreate this image exactly as it is. Make sure it is very detailed."**

What the model will generate:

A complete JSON breakdown containing:

- Age range of subject
- Ethnicity details
- Hair color, style, parting, texture
- Clothing details
- Lighting specifications
- Color grading information
- Composition elements
- Background details

The more detailed the JSON, the better your final output.

Step 3: Use the JSON to Generate Your New Image

Open a new Gemini session with Nano Banana Pro selected.

Your prompt structure: **"Use this JSON as reference: [paste full JSON here]. Now generate [describe what you want]."**

Example:

"Use this JSON as reference: [full JSON code]. Now generate a woman holding my product on a beach."

Attach your product image or any element you want to include.

Step 4: Generate and Refine

Hit generate.

The model will create an image that:

- Maintains the realistic quality from your reference
- Includes your specified elements (product, person, setting)
- Preserves the color grading and lighting style
- Looks natural and professional

Practical Example: Clothing Brand Campaign

Starting scenario: You want to showcase your "Comfrt" hoodie on a model in a coffee shop setting.

Step by step execution:

01

Find a Pinterest image of a woman in a coffee shop with the aesthetic you want

02

Upload to Gemini 3 Pro

03

Request detailed JSON extraction

04

Copy the generated JSON

05

Open new Gemini session with Nano Banana Pro

06

Paste JSON plus prompt: "Generate this photo but put her in the hoodie attached"

07

Attach your hoodie product image

08

Generate

Result: A realistic image of a model wearing your hoodie in a coffee shop, maintaining the professional look and color grading of your reference image.

Platform Recommendations

AI Studio (ai.studio)

This is the preferred platform for this workflow because:

- More granular control over model settings
- Better

Advanced Techniques

Modifying the JSON for Custom Visions

You don't have to use the JSON exactly as generated.

Iterative refinement process:

1. Take your base JSON
2. Paste it back into Gemini
3. Describe the changes you want
4. Ask the model to update the JSON based on your vision
5. Use the modified JSON for generation

Example modifications:

> - "Keep this JSON but change the lighting to golden hour"
> - "Maintain the style but make the setting more urban"
> - "Preserve the color grading but add more warmth"

This lets you dial in exactly what you're visualizing while keeping the realism intact.

Use Cases Beyond Clothing

E-commerce Products:

- Find reference of someone holding a similar product
- Extract JSON
- Replace with your product image
- Generate multiple scenarios

AI Influencer Content:

- Build character consistency across posts
- Maintain color grading throughout feed
- Create cohesive brand aesthetic

Product Photography:

- Generate lifestyle shots
- Create multiple angles and settings
- Test different contexts without physical shoots

Settings and Configuration

Recommended settings in AI Studio:

Model

Nano Banana Pro

Resolution

2K OR 4K

Aspect ratio

Match your reference (common ratios are 9:16, 4:3, 4:5)

Thinking mode

High (for better JSON generation)

Common Issues and Solutions

Problem: Image still looks grayscale	Solution: Your reference image might have muted colors. Choose a Pinterest reference with vibrant, warm lighting.
Problem: Product doesn't integrate naturally	Solution: Make sure your product image has clean edges and good lighting. Use a high quality product photo.
Problem: Character doesn't match reference well	Solution: Request a more detailed JSON. Specifically ask for granular facial feature descriptions.
Problem: Lighting looks off	Solution: Modify the JSON to specify exact lighting conditions you want (golden hour, soft window light, studio lighting, etc).

The Results You Should Expect

With JSON prompting:

- Warm, realistic lighting
- Natural color grading
- Professional looking compositions
- Products that integrate seamlessly
- Images you can use directly in campaigns

Without JSON prompting:

- Grayscale or limited color palette
- Flat lighting
- Less realistic overall appearance
- Inconsistent quality

The difference is dramatic. JSON prompting is not optional if you want usable, professional results from Nano Banana Pro.

Final Workflow Summary

1

Pinterest

Find reference aesthetic

2

Gemini 3 Pro

Extract detailed JSON

3

Nano Banana Pro

Generate with JSON plus your custom prompt

4

Iterate and refine as needed

This method works for any use case where you need realistic AI generated imagery with professional quality color and lighting.